

1. Radxa's Q8B has 2x the performance and expansion of the Pi 5

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 15:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/radxa-q8b-double-pi-5/>

There was a time I'd look at a board like the Radxa Dragon Q8B (at left, above) and be like, "there's no way I'd spend \$209 on an SBC with 8 gigs of RAM". But we're in 2026, and seeing the 8 gig Raspberry Pi 5 going for almost the same amount, I figured I'd give it a shot. On paper, the Q8B beats the Pi 5 in pretty much every way. A lot of that is thanks to this Snapdragon 8cx Gen 3 chip, which is the same chip I tested on Microsoft's Windows Dev Kit 2023.

2. Quoting The New York Times

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-10T02:04:12+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/10/the-new-york-times/>

Anthropic detailed the activity of its A.I. agents in a blog post on Friday, without naming the targeted websites. But two sources with knowledge of the incidents said Anthropic's A.I. agents had submitted 20 visa applications through a form available on the State Department's website. All the applications were incomplete and were not processed, they said. ? The New York Times, Anthropic Agents Tried to Fill Out Visa Forms on State Dept. Website Tags: accidental-cyberattacks, anthropic, generative-ai, ai, llms

3. Deno is joining Cloudflare

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-09T22:48:37+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/9/deno-is-joining-cloudflare/>

Deno is joining Cloudflare The Deno team released the first version of celld back in August - their open source implementation of the Durable Objects pattern from Cloudflare Workers. Today, Cloudflare are acquiring Deno outright, with the goal of building on celld to "make workerd self-hosting a first-class supported way to build and run apps using the Workers programming model" (see the Cloudflare blog.) The bad news is that Deno itself will not be maintained by Cloudflare beyond the next year: We will support the Deno runtime for another year with monthly releases containing bug fixes and security updates. After that year we will end our development of the Deno runtime. Deno will remain open source, and we welcome others who want to continue its development. Deno (and Node.js) creator Ryan Dahl explained that decision in a comment on Hacker News: It's a joint decision and I agree with it. I'm most invested in its success and have put the most work into it - and I no longer think it's where I can do the most important work. There are some good ideas in Deno and it's well engineered - but it ultimately is not solving big problems. It has been sucked into the gravity well of node...

4. Quoting Matthew Green

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-10-09T15:02:29+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/9/matthew-green/>

Everyone is very concerned about being respectable, so I'm going to be the goofball who raises worst-case possibilities. I think there is a 1% chance we live in Minicrypt, and a 15% chance we functionally lose confidence in our existing public-key encryption algorithms. [...] The problem here is that the speed of AI producing surprises, and the speed of human beings replacing standards (even with the very best AI assistance) are just orders of magnitude different. You only recover from a surprise like this if you do the preparation in advance. ? Matthew Green, on Twitter. I looked it up and Minicrypt is Russell Impagliazzo's hypothetical world in which public-key encryption is impossible. Tags: ai-security-research, matthew-green, cryptography, standards, llms, ai, generative-ai

5. I Was Not Blown Away by Eli Tan's ?I Was Blown Away? Review of Meta Muse

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T14:41:29Z

Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/09/22/technology/meta-muse-ai-agent.html?unlocked_article_co

de=1.D1E.Wram.T8Ww85vXKKYU

Eli Tan, writing for The New York Times, ?I Gave My Life Over to Meta?s A.I. Agent and Was Blown Away? (gift link): For one final task, I asked Wren for a good way to spend that \$44.99 it had saved me. At this point, it knew my life pretty well. I thought it might suggest something altruistic, like donating the money to charity or buying flowers for my girlfriend, who was recovering from surgery. Instead, it suggested something even better ? buying bowls from Heath Ceramics , a local ceramics maker with a dedicated following, on Facebook Marketplace, one of my favorite pastimes. Reading Tan?s ?blown away? review (which words only appear in the headline, but it?s his byline under it) made me feel like I was on a hidden camera show. Like I?ve been told I?m about to be served some blow-you-away good coffee and what I?m tasting sure tastes like Folger?s fucking crystals . I?m not saying Muse isn?t capable of blow-you-away things, but I sure didn?t read any of them in Tan?s review. And then, at the end, it steers him toward buying something from ... Meta?s own Facebook Marketplace? And the reaction isn?t a hard eye roll? I get the feeling that Tan believes he?s supposed to be impressed...

6. ? AppZapper 3000

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-23T17:31:23Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/09/appzapper_3000

Is it absolutely ridiculous and unnecessary to make an uninstall utility with an exquisitely detailed 3D laser gun as its UI? Fuckin?-A right it is.

7. Software's centaur age may last decades

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 10 Oct 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/software-s-centaur-age-may-last-decades/>

We are currently living in the age of centaurs (2022-20??). Right now, human engineers paired with AI coding systems are more effective than either by themselves. For future generations of software engineers ? human or otherwise ? this will be the most significant fact about the current period. As in chess?s own centaur age, people are always ready to claim that the centaur age is over and the age of AI supremacy has begun. But the age of centaurs in chess lasted about twenty years, and previous centaur ages have lasted far longer . This should be encouraging to many of us. If software engineering goes along similar lines, we may be able to ride it out another decade or two: enough to make serious plans about what comes next, or to finish out our careers entirely. A brief history of the centaur age It began with GitHub Copilot, which launched in 2022 as AI-powered autocomplete. A confident engineer who knew exactly what they wanted could tab-complete their way through lines of code and sometimes entire functions. Being able to chat with language models like GPT-4 provided the next upgrade. Although the models would still get things wrong, it was helpful to have a generalist on tap...

8. FBI Arrests Founder of Ransomware Negotiation Firm

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Sat, 10 Oct 2026 00:17:42 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/10/fbi-arrests-founder-of-ransomware-negotiation-firm/>
Agents with the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) on Thursday arrested the co-founder of a Canadian cybersecurity firm in connection with an investigation into the ShinyHunters hacking group that recently relieved the FBI of sensitive data on thousands of agents, multiple sources tell KrebsOnSecurity.

9. Pluralistic: Thwarted (09 Oct 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 19:48:39 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/09/impunitism/>

Today's links Thwarted: Behold the awesome destructive power of a fully operational billionaire. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Anthrax v National Inquirer; Grey goo v Second Life; Predictive policing v actual crime; Spooky cookies; California v algorithmic price-fixing; Tivo self-destructs; Disney exec endorses piracy; TSA v

geologists; Handheld printer; Mandatory DRM for all Canadian music sales; Iceweasel; "Snuff"; "Shade the Changing Girl"; Latam surveillance; Scotland Yard brands encryption terrorism; RBS slaughtered 10k small businesses to seize and sell their assets; Dead Letters. Upcoming appearances: Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Sheffield, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Thwarted (permalink) There are many ways in which every billionaire is a policy failure, but the most corrosive and destructive way in which billionaires are policy failures is this: billionaires, despite being unelected and unaccountable, possess the power to control ? and ruin ? millio...

10. Concert Review: London Voices - Video Games Go Choral ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 11:34:09 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/concert-review-london-voices-video-games-go-choral/>

London's musical entertainment scene has something for everyone - from long-running blockbuster shows to no-name bands in dingy basements. Somewhere in the middle is monophonic plainchant versions of the Halo theme sung in a church. The acoustics at St Martin in the Field are echoey. That makes it rather hard to hear the amplified announcement to turn off our phones, but makes an a cappella?

11. No Man Is an Island

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 00:00:00 +1100

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/no-man-is-an-island>

AI makes intellectual contribution superfluous.

12. Premium: The Hater's Guide To Junk

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 15:53:00 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-haters-guide-to-junk/>

Ladies and gentlemen, we are in a glorious, splendiferous, outrageous era of crap! Some call it ?high-yield,? some call it ?speculative-grade,? but to those of us living in the real world, we know them as junk bonds, the formerly-sleepy world of below-

13. Fun with low-rank vocab matrices (and a bonus test loss reduction?)

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 16:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthoras.com/2026/10/low-rank-vocab-matrices>

I was nerdsniped ! On the HF discussion page for one of the models I created for my previous post , AndrewThompson1233 asked if I'd considered trying out factorised embeddings -- something he's using for his model, Maba, and which was previously used in some other models, like ALBERT . It's a really nifty idea; you use a similar trick to LoRA as a way of reducing the number of parameters used for your embeddings and your output head. And for small models, those can be a disproportionate number of the total. For example, with my 163 million parameter GPT-2 small-style models, the embeddings are about 39 million of them ; the output head is the same size, so with those two taken together, that's half the model just getting stuff in and out rather than actually doing the thinking. Even if you use weight tying, like the original GPT-2 models did, you'll wind up spending 30% of your "budget" on the single matrix shared between embeddings and the output head. Similarly, while larger models have a smaller percentage spent that way, even medium-sized MoE models can wind up spending a lot of the active parameters on embeddings; I calculated that for Qwen 3.6 35B MoE, with 3B active paramet...

14. Lobbying

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-10-10T00:00:00+08:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io/blog/jekyll/update/2026/10/10/lobbying.html>

Have you tried to explain lobbying to a non American unfamiliar with the concept? You see, the corporations and rich people write checks to the politicians. No no, not to them directly, sorry, to their reelection campaigns. Then the politicians listen to what the people who paid

them have to say and pass laws based on that. No but like, the money isn't for the laws, it's for like, TV ads and fancy haircuts and private jets and stuff. It's not a bribe. It's for their Super PAC. All above board. It's like, they do what the people with the money want, they get the money, and they continue to have a successful career in politics. No no, it's not bribery. Bribery is super illegal in America. It's like, the politicians need help knowing what laws to pass. So rich people come and help them. And they also give them money. How much money? Oh, that depends how helpful they are. And if they were really helpful, they can leave the politics and get a nice consulting job with the people who lobbied them after. Then the money goes right in their pocket. No no no that can't be a bribe you see, that happens after the laws were passed, a bribe would have to be before. You just don't get it cause y...

15. Name Shame

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-10-09T18:53:35Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17493045/nominative-antideterminism-history>

The concept of nominative antideterminism, or when your name goes against everything that you represent, whether intentionally or not. Cecil Fielder, sadly, wasn't a great fielder.

16. An Ion Storm!, Part 1: The Ascent to Gamer Paradise

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 09 Oct 2026 16:10:11 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/10/an-ion-storm-part-1-the-gamers-penthouse/>

This article tells part of the story of John Romero. At id, the company was rolling in millions of dollars and we just had walls. It was the whole Carmack idea of, 'I don't need anything on my walls, all I need is a table and a computer and a chair,' instead of, 'Okay, we've [?]